

- ▶ When the machine has finished rebooting, choose the second item from the Console Setup menu “Set LAN IP Address”.
- ▶ When prompted whether you want to use DHCP, choose Yes unless your network is set up with static IP addresses.
- ▶ At the next prompt, select “AutoConfiguration for IPv6.”
- ▶ The OS will then give you the IP address that’s been assigned to the NAS box. You can ping your NAS box in order to ascertain if it has joined your network,
- ▶ You can manage the settings of your NAS box using your web browser. Just type the NAS box’s IP address into your browser’s address bar. (The default user name is “admin” and the password is “freenas”).

Configure your drive

Once you’ve logged into the web GUI, you’ll want to take a shot at a few important configuration steps:

- ▶ Start by clicking General (in the left-hand menu stack, under the System heading) and change the desired information in the large pane on the right.
- ▶ Change the name of the NAS.
- ▶ Set the correct date, time, and time zone.
- ▶ Create a unique username and password.
- ▶ Click the Password tab, type in the existing password (“freenas”), and enter your new password in the two boxes provided. You’re now ready to prepare your hard drive.
- ▶ Go back to the left-hand menu and choose Management under the Disks heading.
- ▶ The plus sign inside the circle on the right-hand pane indicates that you can add an element to the NAS.
- ▶ Click the plus symbol and all the drives in your system will appear in the window next to the disk heading. Choose your hard drive.
- ▶ Make sure that the value for “Preformatted file system” is set to “unformatted” before you click the Add button; then click “Apply Changes”.

Format and mount the hard drive

Are you ready to wipe your drive? What you need to do, is return to the “Disks” heading in the left-hand column of the NAS box’s administrative options and choose the Format option. From the dropdown menu select your hard drive and enter a volume label. Accept the remaining default